

Change Proposal CP-2026-002

Per-Action Last-Directory Persistence — Bundle Mode Dialogs

Project:	Bundle File Tool v2.1	Proposal ID:	CP-2026-002
Author:	John (Lead Dev)	Date:	2026-07-08
Reviewers:	Ringo (Owner), George (Architect), Paul (Lead Analyst)	Status:	PROPOSED — awaiting team agreement
Baseline:	bundle_file_tool_v2_src_consolidated_20260708.zip	Deliverable:	proposed_bundle_frame.py (complete file)

1. Defect Statement

In Bundle mode, the Select Source and Create Bundle dialogs do not maintain independent last-used folder paths. After using Select Source, clicking Create Bundle opens the save dialog in the source folder rather than the last bundle-output folder. Reported by Ringo with screenshot evidence (2026-07-07); reproduced and root-caused by John.

2. Root Cause (verified against consolidated baseline)

(a) BundleFrame.select_source() reads global_settings.input_dir for initialdir but never writes the chosen directory back to configuration; ConfigManager.set()/save() are invoked nowhere in bundle_frame.py. (b) BundleFrame.create_bundle() calls filedialog.asksaveasfilename() with no initialdir argument at all, so Tk falls back to its process-global "last dialog directory," which is shared across every dialog in the application. The save dialog therefore inherits whatever folder the Select Source dialog last visited — exactly the reported behavior.

3. Proposed Change

File: src/ui/bundle_frame.py — version 2.1.0 → 2.1.1. Two new internal helper methods and edits to two existing methods. No public interface, DOM ID, endpoint, or signature changes. Complete replacement file supplied as updates/proposed_bundle_frame.py per pyprojectmgr workflow.

Entity	Kind	Action	Lifecycle Proposal
BundleFrame._get_last_dir()	function (internal)	ADD	Proposed
BundleFrame._remember_last_dir()	function (internal)	ADD	Proposed
BundleFrame.select_source()	function	MODIFY (behavior-preserving + persistence)	remains Proposed
BundleFrame.create_bundle()	function	MODIFY (adds initialdir + persistence)	remains Proposed
global_settings.last_source_dir	config key	ADD	Proposed
global_settings.last_bundle_save_dir	config key	ADD	Proposed

Justification for new symbols (per Team Directives, "New Symbols & Functions"): the two helpers centralize get-with-fallback and persist-non-critically logic used by both dialogs, preventing duplicated try/except blocks and giving unbundle_frame.py a ready pattern for the same fix in a follow-up proposal. Single-underscore internal naming per house style. No existing function with equivalent purpose exists in the codebase (verified by search of the consolidated baseline).

4. Design Notes

- New config keys live under `global_settings`, which ConfigManager migration explicitly preserves for unknown keys (Option A, approved by Ringo) — older builds ignore them safely; no schema version bump required.
- Legacy fallback: when a per-action key is unset, the dialog falls back to the existing `input_dir` / `output_dir` keys, preserving current behavior for first-time use.
- Stale-path guard: a remembered folder that no longer exists yields "" so Tk uses its default rather than erroring.
- Persistence failures (read-only config, disk error) are swallowed deliberately — remembering a folder is a convenience and must never block bundling. This mirrors ConfigManager backup semantics.
- `create_bundle()` persists the parent directory of the chosen save path, after user confirmation but before the write, so the folder is remembered even if a later write fails.

5. Zero-Regression Evidence

AST-level scope check against the consolidated baseline confirms exactly two methods changed (`select_source`, `create_bundle`), exactly two added (`_get_last_dir`, `_remember_last_dir`), zero removed, and no other class member touched. Full file compiles (`py_compile` PASS). Headless behavioral tests PASS: (1) the two actions remember different folders independently; (2) values persist across a fresh ConfigManager session; (3) stale paths fall back cleanly; (4) absent `config_manager` degrades to current behavior; (5) keys round-trip through `bundle_config.json` under `global_settings`.

6. Test Plan (manual, Windows 11 dev environment)

1. Select Source → pick folder A → verify tree populates. 2. Create Bundle → dialog must open at `output_dir`/Tk default, not folder A → save into folder B. 3. Select Source again → opens at A. 4. Create Bundle again → opens at B. 5. Restart app, repeat 3–4 (persistence). 6. Delete folder B on disk, Create Bundle → opens at Tk default without error. 7. Regression sweep: Copy to Clipboard, profile switch, preview refresh, Un-bundle mode dialogs unchanged.

7. Deployment Path

Place `proposed_bundle_frame.py` in `updates/` → `pyprojmgr scan` (marks Proposed) → team sign-off recorded → `pyprojmgr qc` clean pass → `pyprojmgr deploy` (backup + promote). Catalog updates: function catalog +2 internal symbols; config-key catalog +2 keys; relationships table: both dialogs already map to their UI buttons — no relationship rows change.

8. Out of Scope / Follow-ups

CP-2026-003 (suggested): apply the identical pattern to `unbundle_frame.py` Open Bundle / Browse Output dialogs. Also outstanding from the consolidation report: `writer.py` RELPATH one-liner decision, missing `tests/conftest.py`, and test-suite drift versus `writer v2.1.11`.

Appendix A — Patched Methods (excerpt from proposed_bundle_frame.py v2.1.1)

```
def _get_last_dir(self, key: str, fallback_key: str) -> str:
    """Return the remembered directory for a dialog, or a sensible fallback."""
    if not self.config_manager:
        return ""
    directory = self.config_manager.get(key, "") or \
        self.config_manager.get(fallback_key, "")
    # Stale paths (deleted/renamed folders) fall back to Tk default.
    if directory and not Path(directory).is_dir():
        return ""
    return directory

def _remember_last_dir(self, key: str, directory: str):
    """Persist a successfully used dialog directory to config (non-critical)."""
    if not self.config_manager or not directory:
        return
    try:
        self.config_manager.set(key, str(directory))
        self.config_manager.save()
    except Exception:
        pass # Non-critical: remembering the folder is a convenience only.

def select_source(self):
    """Open directory browser to select source."""
    directory = filedialog.askdirectory(
        title="Select Source Directory",
        initialdir=self._get_last_dir(
            "global_settings.last_source_dir",
            "global_settings.input_dir"
        )
    )
    if not directory:
        return
    # CP-2026-002: remember this folder for the next Select Source only.
    self._remember_last_dir("global_settings.last_source_dir", directory)
    ... # (remainder of method unchanged)

def create_bundle(self):
    """Create bundle file from selected files."""
    if not self.source_path or not self.current_manifest:
        return
    # CP-2026-002: open in the last bundle-save folder, NOT wherever the
    # process-global Tk dialog memory happens to point.
    file_path = filedialog.asksaveasfilename(
        title="Save Bundle AS",
        defaultextension=".txt",
        filetypes=[("Bundle files", "*.txt"), ("All files", "*.*")],
        initialdir=self._get_last_dir(
            "global_settings.last_bundle_save_dir",
            "global_settings.output_dir"
        ),
        initialfile=f"{self.source_path.name}_bundle.txt"
    )
    if not file_path:
        return
    # CP-2026-002: remember this folder for the next Create Bundle only.
    self._remember_last_dir(
        "global_settings.last_bundle_save_dir",
        str(Path(file_path).parent)
    )
    ... # (remainder of method unchanged)
```